Japanese Language Society



Fourth Meeting | 4回目の対面

Agenda

- “To be” verb and the て Form
  - “To be”
    - ある (inanimate)
    - いる (animate)
  - て form
- Demonstrative Nouns



PART I: Aru

あ る

Aru / ある

- ある means “to be” or “to exist” in Japanese.
- It is different from いる because it is only used for inanimate objects and concepts.

山がある

- There is a mountain.
- Very versatile, for example:

話し合う必要があります。

- [We] need to have a conversation.
- Or literally: A need for a conversation together exists.

PART II: Iru

いる

Iru / いる

- いる also means “to be” or “to exist” in Japanese.
- いる is used for animate objects.

犬がいる。

- “A dog is there / exists.”
- Animate objects are defined in Japanese as something that has the potential for motion, so:
  - Animals, people
  - Even vehicles or machines, in some context

PART III: て Form

て形

て Form

- The て form is one of the most importable verb forms in Japanese.
- It is used as a soft imperative.

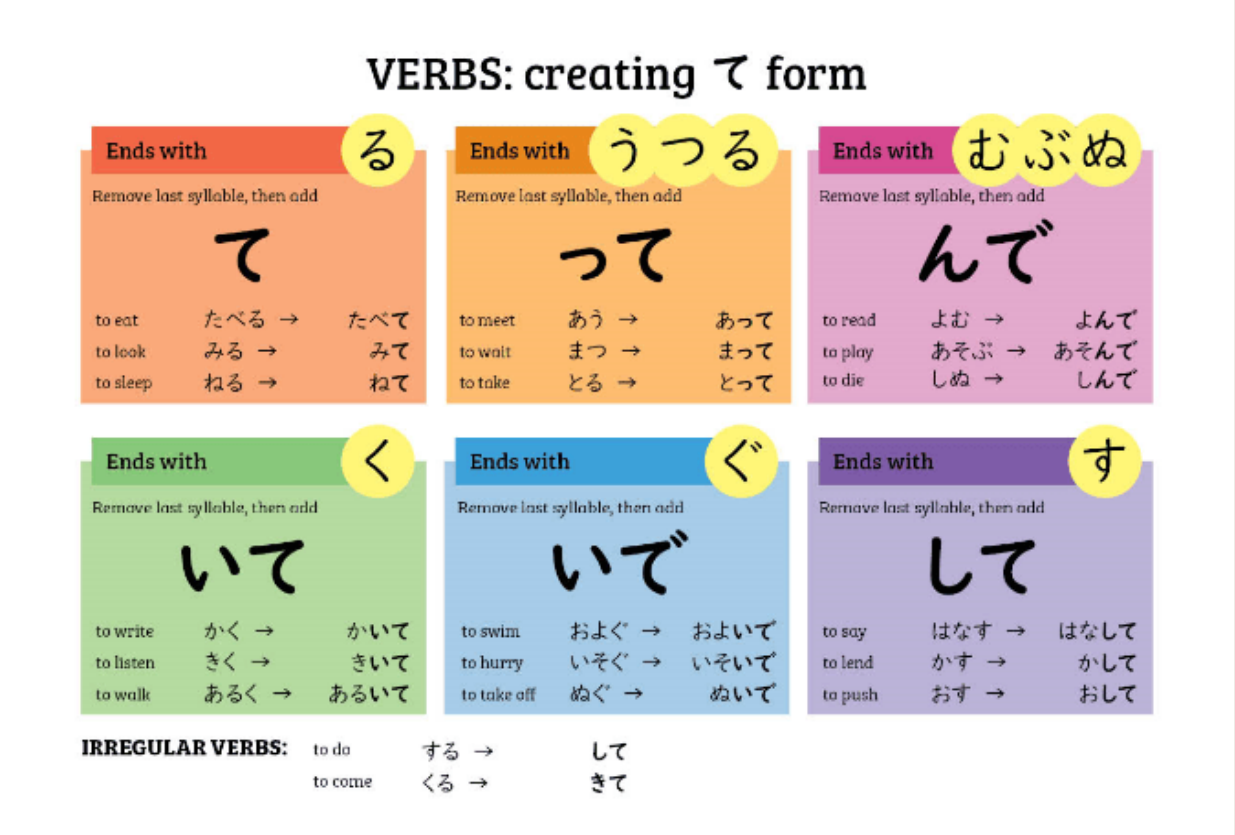
食べる → 食べて

- A gentle request for the listener to eat.

- て can also be used as a form of “and” for い adjectives.

よくて安い

- “Good and cheap.”
- Conjugate these adjectives to て form as you usually conjugate them, with く.



て Form Combining Verbs

- Theて form can be used to combine two verbs and their meaning.
- We will look at 2 common combinations
  - いる
  - ください

- Conjugating the first verb to theて form and then adding いる creates that verb's continuous tense.

食べている

- Combines the verbs "to eat" and "to be", so literally "to eat and to exist"
- This translates to "eating".

- ください is a formal verb that means "to give" or "to bestow"
- We can attachください to a verb in itsて form to make a polite request.

こちらへ来てください

- This would be translated to "come here please."

お願いします / onegaishimasu

- お願いします is similar to ください in that it's used to politely ask for something.
- Unlike ください—which means "please give me"—お願いします more so means "I humbly request a favor/ I trust you with..."
- It's not really used with て form though.

- ください is usually for direct actions/objects.
- お願いします is usually for services.

- Examples:
  - お茶をください。
    - (A tea please.)
  - 駅までお願いします。
    - (Until the station please.)

PART IV:
Demonstrative Nouns

指示名詞

Kocchi, Socchi, and Acchi

	こ Close to the speaker	そ Close to the listener	あ Far from both parties	ど Question word
～っち	こっち This way	そっち That way	あっち That way over there	どっち Which way？
～れ	これ This	それ That	あれ That over there	どれ Which
～の	この This [noun]	その That [noun]	あの That [noun] over there	どの Which [noun]?
～こ	ここ Here	そこ There	あそこ Over there	どこ Where?

- Japanese has these groups of demonstrative nouns, which follow these simple patterns.
- These are the basic demonstrative nouns you will see in Japanese.
- These can have more abstract meanings, like using こっち as an informal personal pronoun.

Thank you!

ありがとうございます